

Inside Facebook's Engineering Culture: Part 1

A broad and deep dive in how Facebook / Meta works, from the perspective of SWEs and EMs.



GERGELY OROSZ

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Facebook – renamed Meta in October 2021 – is the world’s second most-used company by the number of users. At ~3.6B monthly users, it is second only to Google by this metric, meaning every second person on planet Earth uses a Facebook product.

Facebook also owns three of the four most-used social media networks by number of monthly users: Facebook (#1), WhatsApp (#3) and Instagram (#4). Only Google’s YouTube (#2) stops Facebook from locking out the top 4 places in the chart of most popular social media networks.

Facebook was founded not even 20 years ago, in 2004. Gaining market dominance and solidifying it across social media globally, was done at unprecedented speed by the company.

Today, this Big Tech giant has more than 75,000 employees worldwide, and about 32,000 of them work on the tech side. Since its founding, Facebook is the only major tech company to have a founding software engineer lead the company, with Mark Zuckerberg as CEO.

But what is it really like to work at Facebook? What is the culture like? How do teams get things done? What are processes and approaches that engineers use?

This issue is about “things software engineers and engineering managers should know about Facebook’s engineering culture.” While the information is especially useful for anyone planning to join the company, the utility of these details go well

beyond that workplace. Facebook has grown blazingly fast to achieve global dominance; many of its unconventional methods might serve other tech companies hoping to grow with similar speed, just as well.

In this article, I am referring to Meta as “Facebook”. This is because the company rebrand happened recently, late last year. At the same time, the vast majority of details about the engineering culture come from the period when the company was called Facebook. I am also doing this in order to avoid using the Meta/Facebook phrase for those few details post-2021, and to not cause confusion by switching to a different name of “Facebook,” when discussing practices before October 2021.

Because of the length, the article is published in two parts: this is part one of a two-part series.

This series contains more information about Facebook’s engineering culture than any publication has revealed before. In writing this article, I talked with more than a dozen current and former Facebook / Meta software engineers, engineering managers, and engineering directors in verifying the details of this article. The majority of the people I talked with had more than 3 years’ tenure at Facebook.

Still, it’s not possible to capture every single detail about an organization with tens of thousands of software engineers. Facebook gives high autonomy to both individuals and teams to decide how they work. I can’t cover all that variety, but I try to provide a useful overview.

In this issue, we cover:

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For a similar deepdive on Amazon, see the article [Inside Amazon's Engineering Culture](#).

1. Overview

Vocabulary

Below are terms frequently used within Facebook.

- **Workplace:** Facebook's corporate version which the company heavily uses. Think of it as a mix of wikis, documentation, Slack and social.
- **SWE:** Software Engineer working on core products and platforms. Not to be confused with Solutions Engineers, Business Engineers, Partner Engineers, Developer Support Engineers or Enterprise Engineers.
- **PE:** Partner Engineer or Production Engineer. **SE:** Solutions Engineer. **EE:** Enterprise Engineer. **MLE:** Machine Learning Engineer.

- **E3, E4, E5, E6:** SWE levels. More detail about these in next week's newsletter and in the article [Engineering Career Paths at Big Tech](#)
- **IC3, IC4, IC5, IC6:** individual contributor levels. For SWEs, they map to the "E" notation. For example, an IC3 SWE and an E3 are the same.
- **PM:** Product Manager. **TPM:** Technical Program Manager. [Read more about TPMs in this article.](#)
- **DS:** Data Scientists. **DE:** Data Engineer.
- **PSC:** Performance Summary Cycle.
- **Pulse:** an anonymous survey of how happy people are about their manager, company leadership, personal experience, etc. Similar to Workday's [Peakon](#) survey.
- **Calibration:** a part of PSC, where managers discuss employees and arrive at final ratings.
- **PID:** Position ID. Same meaning as headcount.
- **PIP:** Performance Improvement Plan.
- **XFN:** cross-functional.
- **Phab:** short for Phabricator, Facebook's internal tool on top of Git and Mercurial. In capabilities, it is similar to that of GitHub.
- **Diff:** synonym to pull request or code change.
- **To land:** to merge a code change. "I'll land that diff" means "I'll merge that Pull Request into the main branch."
- **LGTM** - "Looks Good to Me". Each diff needs to have at least one code review before landing. When doing a review, it's courtesy to leave at least one message. If there is nothing to improve with the code, and no comments to add, most engineers just comment "LGTM" before approving the diff.
- **TLDR:** Too Long, Didn't Read. With so much content on Workplace, the feed can get really long really quick. A concise TLDR for long posts is something that most folks appreciate.

- **KPI:** Key Performance Indicator. Most teams have these indicators which they set out to improve upon in the next period.
- **SEV:** incident level.
- **Archetypes:** role archetypes at E7 and above. Some organizations use archetypes from E6.
- **RSU:** Restricted Stock Unit. This refers to stock that every Facebook employee working in tech receives as part of their compensation package. Read more about [equity for software engineers](#).
- **AE:** Additional Equity (formerly known as DE: Discretionary Equity)
- **MPK:** Menlo Park office, Facebook's HQ.
- **Zuck:** short for Facebook founder and CEO Mark Zuckerberg.
- **Metaversary:** the anniversary of being employed at the company. E.g. "2nd Metaversary" means you've hit 2 years at Meta.

Core Values

As of 2022, the core values of Facebook are [these six](#):

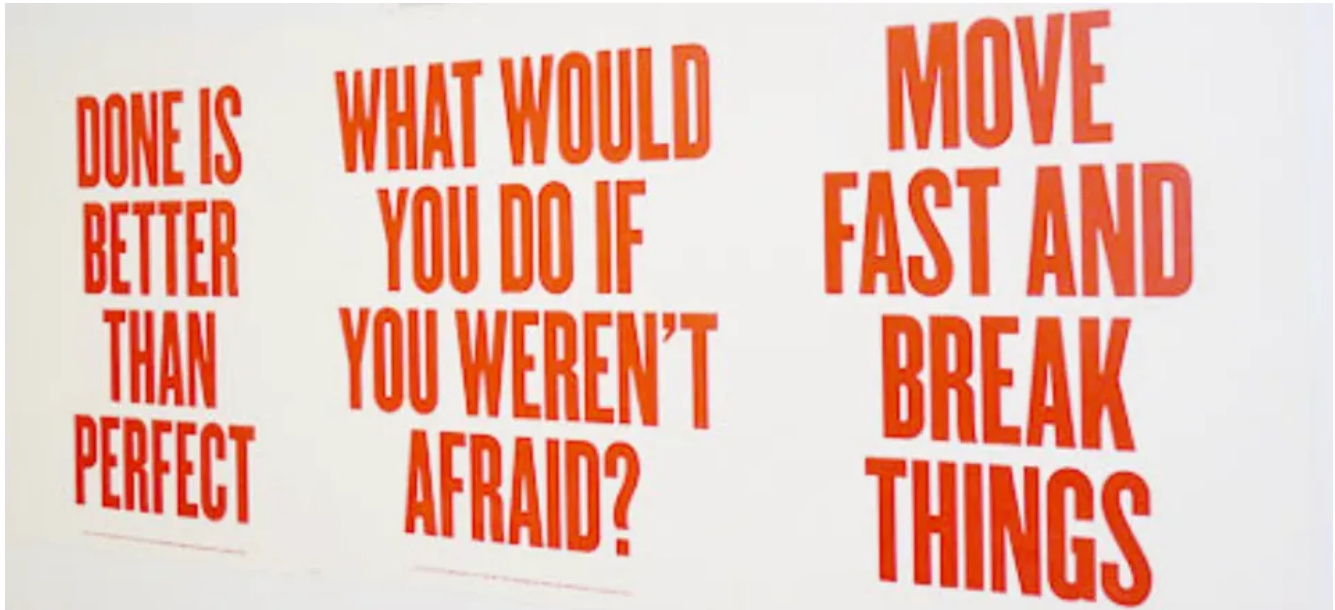
- Move Fast
- Focus on long-term impact
- Build awesome things
- Live in the future
- Be direct and respect your colleagues
- Meta, metamates, me

"Move Fast" is the ethos that can be felt the most across all of Facebook. It originates from the original mantra of "Move Fast and Break Things" and is at the core of Facebook's approach. It's hard to overstate how much this is a part of the culture.

Motivational slogans printed across Facebook's campuses used to be common sights, up until around 2016. Printed in capitals and often in bright red, Facebook had

several sayings which it printed on posters for staff to see. These included:

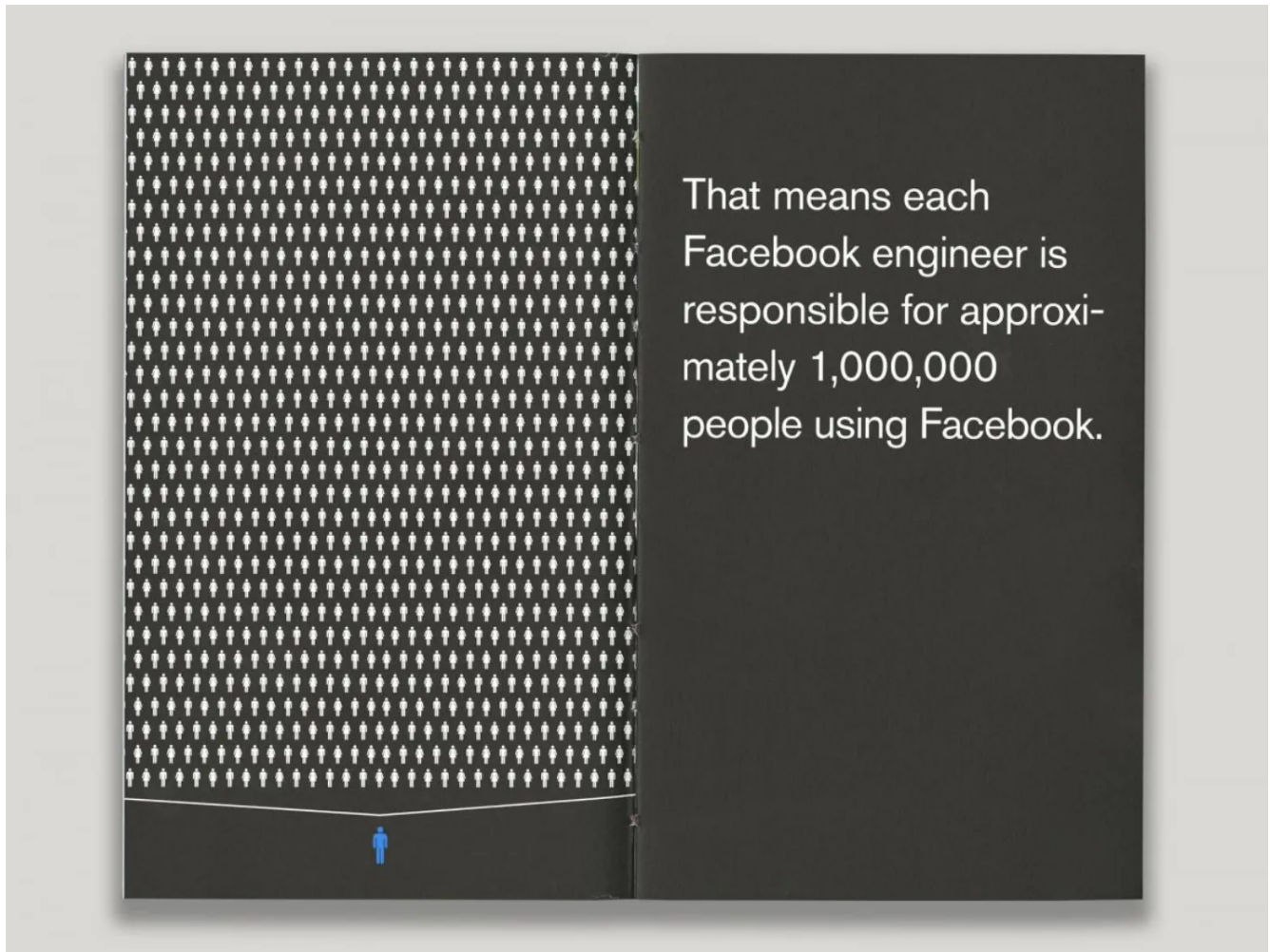
- Move Fast and Break Things
- Done is Better Than Perfect
- Fail Harder
- What Would You Do If You Weren't Afraid?
- Every Day Feels Like a Week
- The Wright Brothers Did Not Have Pilot Licenses
- The Foolish Wait
- Fortune Favors the Bold
- Is This A Technology Company?
- Ruthless Prioritization
- Stay Focused & Keep Shipping
- Think Wrong
- Proceed and Be Bold
- This Journey is Just 1% Finished
- Do Not Mistake Motion for Progress
- Hack Early. Hack Often.
- Be Open
- Be The Nerd
- Fail Convincingly
- Move Fast With Stable Infra



An example of some of Facebook's slogans on its offices' walls.

These posters are now gone. However, for close to 10 years after the company was founded, they dominated the thinking of engineers and their effect can still be felt today.

Reading these slogans might make little sense to those not working at Facebook at the time. Up until around 2014, Facebook distributed its [Little Red Book](#), which was a visual explanation of the culture which these posters referred to. The Little Red Book and the posters were created by the same team. A few pages from the Little Red Book:



"Each Facebook engineer is responsible for approximately 1M people using Facebook" – from Facebook's Little Red Book



"Fast is better than slow" - from Facebook's Little Red Book



"Remember: people don't use Facebook because they like us. They use it because they like their friends." - from Facebook's Little Red Book

Standout differences between Facebook and other Big Tech companies

What are the main differences that set Facebook apart from other Big Tech companies? Here are some of the most visible ones.

The culture is incredibly engineering-centric: much more than most of Big Tech. This might come from Mark Zuckerberg being an engineer himself, or because much of the innovation in the early days of Facebook came from engineers.

Engineers working there whom I spoke with, all shared that it's hard to describe to those outside just how engineer-first Facebook is, how empowered engineers are and

how much freedom they have. The incredible thing is how this culture has persisted to the current size of the company, when it has tens of thousands of employees.

Focus on individual impact. Impact has been the bread and butter of the focus at Facebook. This is very true since the early days, and the focus on generating impact remains.

One detail in common with most Big Tech firms, is that both the engineering culture and general culture focus so much on *individual* impact. This results in some people focusing on short-term, measurable wins and assuming that teamwork and split wins between groups might be less rewarded.

The leadership recognized this was a problem and it's why the People and Collaboration axes were introduced in 2015, and the "Meta, Metamates, Me" culture value added in 2021. Talking with long-tenured managers, directors and engineers, they say that despite introducing these values, there is still a lot of focus on the individual part of the impact.

The lack of rigid processes. Facebook seems to have the least amount of processes or standardization across all of Big Tech. Don't even try to compare it to [Amazon's engineering culture](#) and the countless formal processes there. But even compared to companies like Google, Microsoft or Uber, Facebook's processes are much looser. Most of this comes from the engineering-centric nature of the company and engineers disliking processes.

A quirky tech stack. Everything within Facebook is custom, much more so than at almost all of Big Tech. Google comes closest to a "non-standard tech stack", but Facebook takes it a step further. This quirky tech stack is a good reason why they have — and need! — Bootcamp for onboarding.

Surprisingly little emphasis on testing, documentation or code comments. You'll find shockingly little automated testing and documentation at Facebook, compared to the rest of Big Tech. Inline code comments are also very rare.

Originally, this was a conscious decision in order to both push people to write clean code - with easy to understand variable names and structure - and to foster more

collaboration and personal connection. Instead of reading code comments and documentation that is possibly stale, you have to look at the code, find out who wrote it — or modified it — and connect with them. This approach means building personal relationships, and possibly learning more than you could just from documentation.

A founder-engineer driven company. Facebook is one of the few Big Tech firms whose founder is an engineer, and still is the CEO. Netflix is the other one where founder and co-CEO Reed Hastings was also a software engineer before starting the company. Amazon was the other example of this until recently, but it's not the case at Google or Apple. There are good examples of smaller companies like Cloudflare, but they're all younger than Facebook.

Engineers are product-oriented. They are expected — and are rewarded for — collaborating well with design, product and data science. Engineers tend to represent the [product-minded engineer](#) very closely. They do far more than just deliver on requirements. They frequently define requirements themselves and deliver on those they think will have the highest impact. This is true for the product organizations: Infra orgs are still very engineering oriented, focused on scaling, and engineering metrics.

Levels are hidden across the company. Every software engineer's title is SWE, and every product manager is called Product Manager. For managers, you see Manager (but not if it's M0, M1 or M2), Director (but not if it's D1 or D2) or VP.

It's generally frowned upon to ask about levels and promotions are rarely announced. In practice, people tend to know who are the senior people because they are "famous" internally or many people refer to them — that's one reason they became senior in the first place. However, it's rare that people know the precise level of the senior folks.

Thorough interview preparation support. While the interview process at Facebook is similar to most of Big Tech, they offer far more preparation than many companies. This includes one or more interview preparation calls with the recruiter, an Interview Experience Q&A with other candidates, written resources sent out to candidates, a free mock interview with detailed feedback and the Meta Ambassador program.

Free mock interviews are a recent offering, started to be offered to all candidates around March/April 2022, and are offered to help prepare for coding interviews.

I talked with software engineers who ended up choosing Facebook thanks to all the support they received, sharing how other Big Tech firms they interviewed for did not compare in terms of the support.

Bootcamp. A unique onboarding process, unlike what any other Big Tech firms offer. We cover this more in the Bootcamp & onboarding section, next week.

Own data centers without a cloud offering. Facebook owns and runs their own data centers. While not unique in Big Tech, Facebook is increasingly one of the few companies that don't use well-known cloud providers like AWS, GCP, Azure. Despite this, they are not a cloud provider.

Remote friendliness. Though the company has not gone full-remote like firms such as Twitter or Shopify have, Facebook is far more remote-friendly than, for example, Apple. Facebook has also started to hire for full-remote positions in the US, Canada, and Europe.

The return to the office is yet to fully play out. As of May 2022 the company is permissive about remote working. Up to April 2022, employees could submit requests for exceptions to work full remote. All employees I talked with who applied have been granted this exception. Those who did not apply should, theoretically, be in the office at least 50% of the time, but engineers have not seen this enforced. Remote friendliness starts at the top, and Facebook leaders and execs lead by example, [making full use of remote work](#).

Strong support for internal mobility. It's both easier and more common to move teams within Facebook, well beyond how most other Big Tech companies support such moves.

On the engineering-central culture

Facebook has one of the most engineering-centric cultures in all of Big Tech: only Google comes close in this sense. Here are a few characteristics about this culture.

Engineers get to choose both their teams, and, frequently, their projects. Coming off Bootcamp, it's still not uncommon to join a team where the roadmap for a project is set, and the work needs to be done. However, upon onboarding to the team, engineers are both expected and encouraged to accept more autonomy.

Engineers are responsible for their own impact. A manager cannot just tell an engineer "you have to work on X." If the engineer feels working on X is a bad idea, they can — and should! — push back on doing so.

The tradeoff is that the engineer's choices impact their performance rating. A manager cannot give a good rating for an engineer who has done only low-impact work. This is particularly true if the manager specifically asked the engineer to do the given work. It also means engineers can not use the well-worn excuse of "just following orders" to justify low impact.

It's in the interest of both an engineer to work on high-impact work, and in the manager's interest for all their engineers to do likewise. Because of this alignment, managers tend to suggest work which leads to high impact for the engineer. However, at the end of the day, engineers take responsibility for their work.

To color the above a bit more: E5 (~senior software engineer) is the first level where engineers take full responsibility for their own impact. E3 (~entry-level software engineer) and E4 (~software engineer 2) engineers are evaluated more for their productivity. In practice, this means that managers are much more likely to direct E3 and E4 engineers on what to do; at this level, the impact of their work won't count for their performance review. For E5 and above, managers tend to suggest tasks, as the engineers are now responsible for their own Direction axis.

Engineering is paid above other functions. It's known that engineers and engineering managers on a given level are paid more than other functions. Within software engineering, there's also a divide between the more product and platform-focused SWEs, and everyone else. SWEs are paid about 15-30% above that of Solutions Engineers, Business Engineers, Partner Engineers, Developer Support Engineers or Enterprise Engineers.

Data Scientists (DS) and Data Engineers (DE), however, are paid almost on par with SWEs. Their base salaries are the same, and the difference goes down to RSUs: SWEs sometimes - but not always - get allocated more of this. DEs and SWEs are usually paid the same.

Engineers are not told which processes to run. Nobody comes to a team and tells them they need to run this or that flavor of Agile, or to follow a specific process. What matters is impact. This is not too dissimilar to most of Big Tech which also is [moving away from rigid processes like Scrum](#).

Managers support engineers. No manager says "I manage team X". Managers are trained to say "I support team X."

This may sound like 'touchy-feely' political correctness. However, this is really, truly the Facebook culture: this is how managers tend to operate. Several current and former Facebook managers described their role as a support role, and one where they practiced 'servant leadership.'

Management is not a promotion. There is no such thing as promotion to management at Facebook. It's called a transition, and the company means it. Engineers can make a similar amount of money by staying on the engineering track, than if they move to the manager one.

It's worth noting that for people good at management, it is typically easier to get promoted to M2 than it is for those good at engineering to get to E7, with both levels being equal. This perception of engineer promotions becoming more difficult than manager ones is widely discussed within Facebook, and is subject to lots of internal debate.

On the individualistic culture

Most current and former Facebook engineers and managers mentioned the Facebook culture is somewhat "individualistic". Indeed, this observation came up so often that I felt it necessary to understand this phenomenon.

The performance culture is perceived by many engineers as individualistic.

Engineers have to pick their battles and tend to prioritize only spending time on things they know will contribute positively to their personal goals, which they have set in advance.

Some engineers feel that fixing stuff for other people is quietly discouraged. Some other engineers mentioned how they sense that two people contributing to one feature is a waste of "impact" because it's diluted. It's better for each individual to be the owner of a feature.

Talking to managers at Facebook, they shared how engineers "hogging work" in order to display impact is more common among E5 engineers wanting to get promoted to the E6 level.

According to these managers, most E6+ engineers are usually really good at collaborating and taking credit for leading the work. E5 engineers, who didn't figure out how to make this work yet, often aim to create "big impact" by themselves, to justify their promotion hopes. Once they master how to operate successfully at E6+ levels, this behavior tends to become less common.

This culture can lead to some odd situations. If an engineer works on a project with another engineer, both are collaborating. However, engineers will often agree that for the purposes of reviews (and to make their manager happy), they'll claim one of them did X and the other did Y, even if they worked together on X and Y iteratively.

The importance of cross-functional work (XFN) is significant. Engineers can claim impact by leading efforts with other teams. There's an expectation of "XFN" (cross-functional) work with other teams.

If an engineer identifies a need, gets a bunch of people together and gets something done, then it contributes to their overall impact during review. Getting people together may be done in a chat, in a document, in a group, and so on. When working across groups, engineers make sure their proposal touches or drives the Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) of these other groups.

XFN work being important does mean that sometimes people are *too* eager to get everybody helping out on their pet project, or talking with too many people to get something resolved.

“Creating your network” and getting to know people is important at Facebook.

The focus on impact also reflects how engineering managers steer the engineers. With a network and by knowing enough people, XFN work is much easier.

Engineers are encouraged to make friends with everybody. As a result, most engineers are happy to chat with other engineers, because they get to grow their network by talking with others, and might meet key engineers this way. For example, if they reconnect with an engineer they helped in the past, and pull them into a new project their team runs, then this is a win. Even more, this engineer can “claim” points for the “Direction” axis in the PSC, as using influence to drive impact is what the Direction axis is about.

An unintended consequence of this individualistic performance culture, is that at times it does corrode the feeling of team spirit. It can sometimes feel like you're competing with your own team mates; this is especially true when engineers realize they will be stack ranked at the org-level at the end of the year for performance reviews and bonus outcomes.

While almost all engineers and managers I spoke with agreed that this individualistic culture is typical of Facebook, there was a split on whether this actually impacts collaboration:

- Engineers with a few years' tenure shared how they felt the culture was collaborative and that while some people game the system to get “impact points”, the majority do not.
- Those with longer tenure or at E6-and-above IC levels, were often more salty in this regard, more frequently sharing that individual impact is the way to grow your career.
- Managers I talked with all acknowledged that the individualistic culture is at times an issue. Those no longer with Facebook were less hopeful this has changed,

while those currently at Facebook were more positive and expect to see a change, over time.

Performance cycles have increased from 6 to 12 months to counter the short-term impact focus. Focusing on shipping impact in no more than 6 months benefited Facebook in the early days, but it's now hurting the company. A good example about how critical 6 months was for the company comes from a page of the Little Red Book about it:

It reads:

"6 months or 30 years. There is no point in having a 5-year-plan in this industry. With each step forward, the landscape you're walking on changes. So we have a pretty good idea of where we want to be in six months, and where we want to be in 30 years. And every six months, we take another look at where we want to be in 30 years to plan out the next six months.

"It's a little bit shortsighted and a little bit not. But any other approach guarantees everything you release is already obsolete."



The "6 months or 30 years" section in Facebook's Little Red Book.

Issues with the 6-month Performance Summary Cycle (PSC) were:

- A focus on short-term wins. To ship something in 6 months, engineers probably needed to plan it in ~1 month, ship it in ~3 months, measure it in ~1 month, and document the results for their PSC write-up in the final month.
- Lots of administrative strain with a 6-month PSC cycle.

The administrative strain was especially the case for managers. With the 6-month PSC process in place, managers would be busy with the following activities at different times of the year:

- January: PSC

- February: PSC calibrations
- March: PSC conversations
- April: mid-cycle preparation
- May: mid-cycle feedback
- June: engineers panicking and landing last-minute code changes (diffs) to claim impact for PSC
- July: PSC
- August: PSC calibration
- September: PSC calibration
- October: mid-cycle preparation
- November: mid-cycle feedback
- December: engineers panicking and wanting to land last-minute code changes to claim PSC impact. Except that thanks to code freezes, they can no longer land.

The intention of 12-month PSC cycles is to have people think more "long term." In the 6-month cycle, planning beyond a PSC cycle was extremely hard, and many engineers felt that doing so didn't help their review, and that it often dragged their review down.

The new cultural value of "Meta, Metamates, Me" is an attempt to change the visibly individualistic culture. So far, it's not doing much; current engineers I talked with all shared that they don't pay much attention to this value, as it does not help with performance reviews or promotions, and that it has in no way changed how they work. It looks like it's an uphill battle to make a major cultural shift, breaking with 15-20 years of individual impact deciding how people's performance is rewarded.

Changing culture takes 5+ years at companies this size. Having talked with engineers and managers who have been at Facebook since 2015 — when the People and Collaboration axis was introduced — they shared how the focus on individual impact is still prominent in 2022, despite all the big systematic reform efforts. The new axes do help, but they alone are not sufficient to change a decade-and-a-half of focus on individual impact.

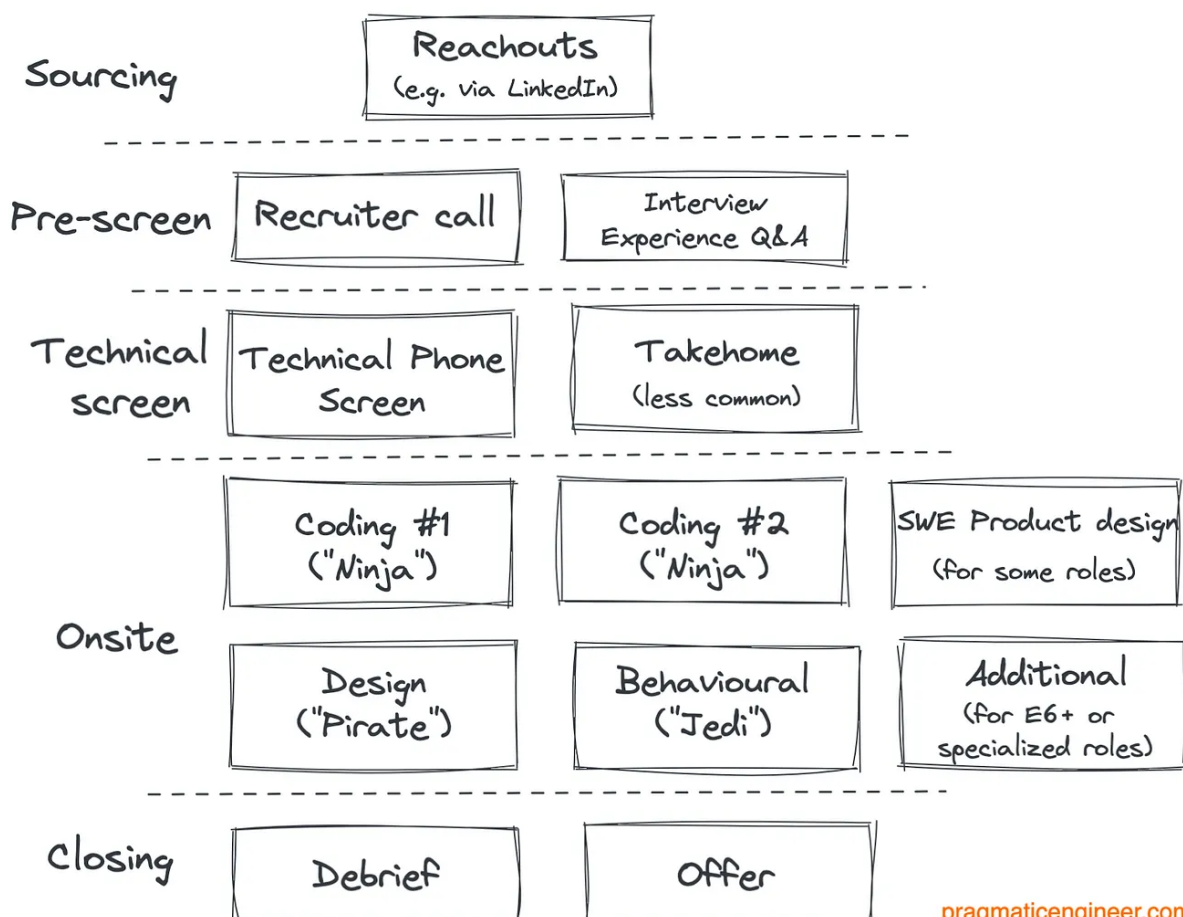
A long-tenured engineering director at Facebook shared how they believe large-scale change efforts often take 5-7 years to manifest in cultural change, both from their own experience at Facebook, and how this rhymes with what author John P. Kotter covers in the book, [Leading Change](#). This director worked at Facebook in 2015 when the People and Collaboration axis was introduced, and they believe that 7 years later, change is finally starting to manifest in cultural change.

2. Hiring

Hiring processes

The Facebook interview process is a typical Big Tech interview process for the generic software engineer position. For software engineers, the interview process is typically structured like this:

Typical SWE interview process at Facebook



A typical software engineering interview process at Facebook. The number of interviews depends on the position, and the seniority of this position.

The phases are as follows:

Sourcing: specialized recruiters named 'outbound sourcers' reach out to candidates. This is done via LinkedIn, over email, and in other creative ways, as they try to contact engineers who might be a fit for the role.

Pre-screen: before starting the technical interview process, a recruiter does a call. This call is typically about gathering more information, as well as sharing details about the interview process. The call is typically up to **45 minutes**; depending on how much time the candidate needs.

Facebook recruiters often send over preparation materials for the rest of the interview process, and frequently schedule preparation calls for the later parts of the process, such as the Onsite. Those who make it through the pre-screen are in contact with the same recruiter for the rest of the process.

Interview Process Q&A. In recent years, Facebook has offered an interview process preparation call for engineers and engineering managers before moving to the technical screen.

Technical screen: a video interview where an engineer collects signals on coding and problem-solving. Typically done as a coding exercise on the spot. For some teams and interview types, a take-home interview to be done in your own time might also be part of this step. Typically **45 minutes**.

Facebook offers extensive advice to prepare for this screen, which advice [is accessible publicly here](#):

How to Prepare

Interviewers can only assess your skills and abilities based on what you show them during your interview, so it's important to plan and prepare to best showcase your strengths. In addition to the preparation guidance below, [this video](#) (password: fbprep) will give you an example of what to expect during your technical screen.

1. Before you practice, plan!

Be honest with yourself—only you know how much prep time you'll need. Make the most of your prep time by following these steps to plan your approach before you start practicing.

- **Schedule time to study and practice.** Block out time every day to write code. Target medium and hard problems.
- **Prioritize breadth over depth.** It's much better to practice solving fewer example problems of many problem types than to become very familiar with one type at the expense of the others.
- **Set aside time to review what you've practiced.** As you solve problems, make cheat sheets or flash cards to review later. Revision and repetition will strengthen your understanding of core concepts.
- **Remember your goal.** Aim for confidently solving two questions—while thinking aloud—in about 35 minutes.

Part of the "Preparing for your Technical Screen" guide from Facebook.

[Access the full guide here.](#)

Onsite: several interviews on the same day. These cover:

- Coding (Facebook refers to this interview internally as "Ninja.")
- Systems design ("Pirate.")
- Behavioral with a hiring manager ("Jedi.")
- SWE Product Design: an interview for frontend, mobile and full-stack positions, introduced for more senior positions.
- Additional interview: for more senior positions, such as E6 and above, it's common to have additional interviews. E6+ usually has two system design interviews. Specialized E5s — like ML, Gaming — have system design (generic) + in-domain

design interviews targeted at their speciality. ML engineers typically have two ML interviews in their loop.

The typical interview loop for E5 or below engineers is **4x45 minutes** in interviews. For more senior positions, or specialized ones, there might be more interviews.

Closing. Following the interviews, Facebook conducts a debrief with all interviewers present and makes a hiring decision. If the hiring decision is a "yes," an offer is drafted and extended.

Hiring Support

Facebook prepares candidates thoroughly for the interview process. They have a self-service recruitment portal at [FacebookRecruiting.com](https://www.facebook.com/recruiting). Here are things on offer, mostly after candidates pass the Technical Screen and prepare for the Onsite:

- A preparation call with the recruiter, where they talk through the process.
- Detailed documentation of the interview process sent out to candidates.
- Interview Experience Q&A with other candidates on the call, covering the format, advice, and questions.
- Mock interview before the tech screen, where the candidate receives detailed written feedback. This interview is similar to what you might see on services like interviewing.io: except it's free and done by interviewers at Facebook.
- The drawing tool for the systems design interview suggested to be done through a white-labeled [Excalidraw](https://www.excalidraw.com/) drawing board - however, candidates are free to use another way to draw and share screens.
- For candidates with diverse backgrounds: access to the Meta Ambassador program. Talk to a Facebook employee of your choice. Facebook lists people from various backgrounds so you can choose someone you feel comfortable talking with.

Here is a peek into what this portal looks like, and what it offers:



Career Profile

HomeInterview PreparationCoding PuzzlesKnowledge LibraryPast ApplicationsMeta Connections

Software Engineer

More preparation material

Learn about engineering interviews at Meta

Whether you've already applied or are still considering it, we're here to help you understand the engineering interview process and learn what you need to do to prepare.



Preview the process

See how people are evaluated at Meta.



Learn at your own pace

Progress through the materials on your own time.



Evaluate your skills

Understand what you need to do to be interview-ready.



What role are you interested in? General Engineering

The landing page at FacebookRecruiting.com

Facebook offers an ambassador program called Meta connections. This is an opportunity to connect with Facebook employees in the discipline you are applying for, and to talk with them. Some details on the program, from Facebook's internal recruitment portal for candidates:


+ 4K Meta Ambassadors
 Meta ambassadors are eager to connect with you and answer your questions.


6 Continents
 Connect with our diverse global community!


+ 9 Diverse groups
 Learn more about our internal communities

How it works



Find Meta ambassador

While you are interviewing at Meta, you can speak to our employee ambassadors to better understand what working at Meta is like. Browse and filter through our ambassador community to connect.



Request to Connect

Once you have selected the ambassador(s) you would like to connect with, schedule your connection to discuss the topics you would like to learn more about.



Chat in 72 hours

Ambassadors will confirm your connection request within 2 business days to connect over phone, email or video chat.

Examples of questions candidates asked

For interview or recruiting related questions, please reach back out to your recruiter.



"How do you manage your work life balance at Meta?"

"What is the day to day office/remote work environment like?"

"What is the company culture like?"



Find Meta Ambassador

Screenshot from the Meta connections page on the internal recruiting portal. When choosing to connect with an ambassador, candidates can track their schedule.

Screenshot from the Meta connections page on the internal recruiting portal. When choosing to connect with an ambassador, candidates can track their schedule.

Coding exercises are offered for practice. These include exercises on arrays, heaps, strings, trees, greedy algorithms, search, recursion, sorting, stacks, hash tables, queues, linked lists, graphs. Each of these categories have 1-3 exercises, for example:

The screenshot displays a grid of algorithm categories and exercises. Each category is represented by a blue icon, a title, and a completion status. Exercises are listed below each category with their own completion status.

Category	Exercises
Greedy algorithms 0/3 exercises completed	☐ Slow Sums ☐ Element Swapping ☐ Seating Arrangements
Trees 0/2 exercises completed	☐ Number of Visible Nodes ☐ Nodes in a Subtree
Search 0/2 exercises completed	☐ Revenue Milestones ☐ 1 Billion Users
Recursion 0/2 exercises completed	☐ Encrypted Words ☐ Change in a Foreign Currency
Sorting 0/2 exercises completed	☐ Balanced Split ☐ Counting Triangles
Stacks 0/1 exercises completed	☐ Balance Brackets
Queues 0/1 exercises completed	

Screenshot from exercises in the Interview Preparation section

To get a sense of these exercises, here is the exercise of Counting Triangles (Sorting) and Queue Removals (Queues):

Counting Triangles

Given a list of **N** triangles with integer side lengths, determine how many different triangles there are. Two triangles are considered to be the same if they can both be placed on the plane such that their vertices occupy exactly the same three points.

Signature

```
int countDistinctTriangles(ArrayList<Sides> arr)
or
int countDistinctTriangles(int[][] arr)
```

Input

In some languages, `arr` is an **N**x3 array where `arr[i]` is a length-3 array that contains the side lengths of the *i*th triangle. In other languages, `arr` is a list of structs/objects that each represent a single triangle with side lengths *a*, *b*, and *c*.

It's guaranteed that all triplets of side lengths represent real triangles.

All side lengths are in the range [1, 1,000,000,000]
 $1 \leq N \leq 1,000,000$

Output

Return the number of distinct triangles in the list.

Example 1

```
arr = [[2, 2, 3], [3, 2, 2], [2, 5, 6]]
output = 2
```

The first two triangles are the same, so there are only 2 distinct triangles.

Example 2

```
arr = [[8, 4, 6], [100, 101, 102], [84, 93, 173]]
output = 3
```

All of these triangles are distinct.

Example 3

```
arr = [[5, 8, 9], [5, 9, 8], [9, 5, 8], [9, 8, 5], [8, 9, 5], [8, 5, 9]]
output = 1
```

All of these triangles are the same.

The Counting Triangles preparation exercise to practice sorting.

[Back to questions list](#)

Queue Removals

You're given a list of n integers `arr`, which represent elements in a queue (in order from front to back). You're also given an integer x , and must perform x iterations of the following 3-step process:

1. Pop x elements from the front of queue (or, if it contains fewer than x elements, pop all of them)
2. Of the elements that were popped, find the one with the largest value (if there are multiple such elements, take the one which had been popped the earliest), and remove it
3. For each one of the remaining elements that were popped (in the order they had been popped), decrement its value by 1 if it's positive (otherwise, if its value is 0, then it's left unchanged), and then add it back to the queue

Compute a list of x integers `output`, the i th of which is the 1-based index in the original array of the element which had been removed in step 2 during the i th iteration.

Signature

```
int[] findPositions(int[] arr, int x)
```

Input

x is in the range $[1, 316]$.
 n is in the range $[x, x*x]$.
 Each value `arr[i]` is in the range $[1, x]$.

Output

Return a list of x integers `output`, as described above.

Example

```
n = 6
arr = [1, 2, 2, 3, 4, 5]
x = 5
output = [5, 6, 4, 1, 2]
```

The initial queue is $[1, 2, 2, 3, 4, 5]$ (from front to back).

In the first iteration, the first 5 elements are popped off the queue, leaving just $[5]$. Of the popped elements, the largest one is the 4, which was at index 5 in the original array. The remaining elements are then decremented and added back onto the queue, whose contents are then $[5, 0, 1, 1, 2]$.

In the second iteration, all 5 elements are popped off the queue. The largest one is the 5, which was at index 6 in the original array. The remaining elements are then decremented (aside from the 0) and added back onto the queue, whose contents are then $[0, 0, 0, 1]$.

In the third iteration, all 4 elements are popped off the queue. The largest one is the 1, which had the initial value of 3 at index 4 in the original array. The remaining elements are added back onto the queue, whose contents are then $[0, 0, 0]$.

In the fourth iteration, all 3 elements are popped off the queue. Since they all have an equal value, we remove the one that was popped first, which had the initial value of 1 at index 1 in the original array. The remaining elements are added back onto the queue, whose contents are then $[0, 0]$.

In the final iteration, both elements are popped off the queue. We remove the one that was popped first, which had the initial value of 2 at index 2 in the original array.

The Queue removals question to practice Queues.

Coding puzzles are another form of interview preparation resource that Facebook offers software engineers. These are split into these categories:

- Warmup: ABCs, All Wrong, Battleship
- Level 1: fundamental data structures and algorithms to solve basic puzzles.
- Level 2: requiring a higher degree of problem solving.
- Level 3: using advanced data structures and algorithms to solve complex problems.
- Level 4: requiring the combining of many advanced concepts.

Ready to get started solving puzzles?

We recommend trying our Warmup puzzles first.

[All puzzles](#) Warmup Level 1 Level 2 Level 3 Level 4 Not solved

Warmup Get familiar with our coding puzzles.**ABCs**

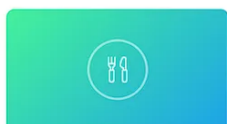
Not started

**All Wrong**

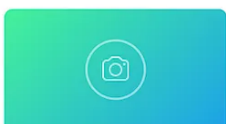
Not started

**Battleship**

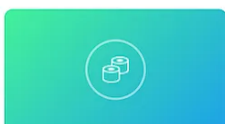
Not started

Level 1 Use fundamental data structures and algorithms to solve basic puzzles.**Cafeteria**

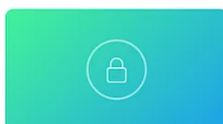
Not started

**Director of Photography 1**

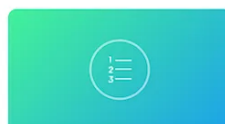
Not started

**Kaitenzushi**

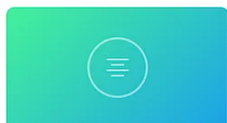
Not started

**Rotary Lock 1**

Not started

**Scoreboard Inference 1**

Not started

**Stack Stabilization 1**

Not started

**Uniform Integers**

Not started

Screenshot from the Coding Puzzles page.

The portal lists frequently asked questions in the Knowledge Library:



Knowledge Library

[Common Questions](#)[Scheduling](#)[Interviewing](#)[Working at Meta](#)

Why did my interview schedule change?

We do our best to provide you with a final interview schedule. Occasionally, however, there are changes. If an interviewer is out sick, for example, we'd try to find another interviewer to replace them. But if no one else is available, we might need to reschedule or cancel that particular interview.

If there are changes to your schedule, they won't affect your status as a candidate or how you're evaluated.

Should I use the same video conference link for all my interviews?

Yes. The same link will work for all of your interviews, even if they're scheduled over multiple days. Just click the link to start the video conference. You'll receive an email with the link through the same email you've been using to communicate with the Recruiting team at Meta. You can also access a Join Video Conference button on your Career Profile [homepage](#), in the "On the agenda" section. This section is available after your interview has been confirmed.

If you have a break between interviews, you can end the video conference, then click the link or button to start the video conference again.

Can I stay in the same video conference for all of my interviews or do I need to rejoin at each scheduled time?

Screenshot from the Knowledge Library section

Software Engineer Hiring

The SWE Product Design interview was introduced in around 2018. This interview is similar to the system design one, but the problem space is closer to the web. Topics this interview might cover include frontend architecture, API design, caching, HTTP protocols.

A Facebook engineer summarized the difference between these two interviews as:

Product design: implement News Feed.

System design: scale News Feed to 2B people.

Certain positions like Frontend or Mobile sometimes have different interview

loops. For example, the frontend loop at Facebook London did not have challenging algorithmic coding questions, and focused more on JavaScript. In 2019, the preparation material sent out to Frontend Engineers read:

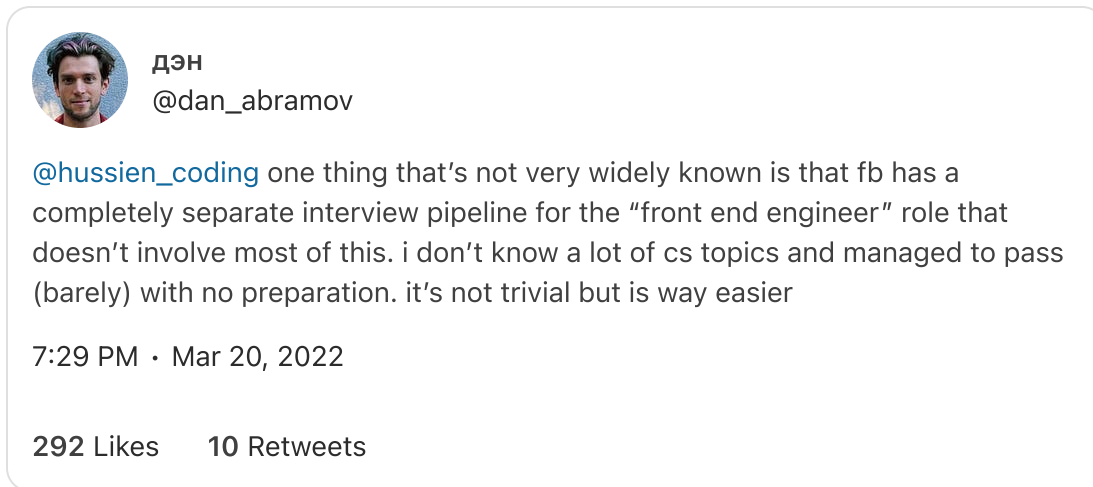
"We'll try to keep it practical and focus on things you might encounter when building apps. We won't ask you to write a sorting algorithm from scratch. But we expect you to know the relative performance of JavaScript object and array operations. You should be able to find and fix bottlenecks in your code, and articulate the tradeoffs that you've made.

"We won't ask you to implement obscure data structures like red-black trees. But it will help to recap data structures common in UI engineering like arrays, maps, sets, and DOM trees. You'll also find it helpful to read about CS topics like Big O notation and tree traversal. We don't expect you to memorize any particular algorithms. It is more important that you can apply these principles in practice to create responsive user interfaces.

"We expect you to know the JavaScript language and its primitives well. This includes topics like iteration, closures, scope and writing asynchronous code. We don't ask about particular libraries - so don't worry about learning React or something similar. However, we do expect UI engineers to understand what's beneath the abstractions they use. For example, if you only wrecked with UI libraries before, spend some time learning the raw DOM APIs. If you only used a utility library like Lodash, try to implement some of its methods from scratch.

"Check how well your solutions will work with large inputs, and think about memory consumption and the edge cases you need to handle. As you practice, talk through your solution and feel free to sketch on paper to aid your thinking. This is a good way to practice for the interview!"

Facebook frontend engineer Dan Abramov shares his thoughts on the frontend interview process:



Other notes on how hiring works at Facebook:

- Engineers are interviewed not for a particular team, but for Facebook, as a whole. This is similar to how Google used to interview and hire engineers.
- E6+ engineers and managers are, however, almost always hired for a specific team. They still go through Bootcamp, but not team matching.
- The number and composition of interviews is very rigid for every position.
- Interviewers give the Hire / No Hire decision, confidence level (e.g. strong / weak hire or no hire), and submit highly detailed notes.
- Candidate Review Committee: this is the committee reviewing all of the submitted notes, and the group which makes the final decision.
- While the process is very formal, outstanding performance outstandingly in all interviews is not expected. It's not uncommon to get an offer despite one interviewer giving a "No Hire" recommendation.
- When in doubt, No Hire is the default approach, though. I made a video on this topic, [Big Tech hiring is conservative](#), and Facebook is no exception.

I write in more detail about Facebook's interview process — and my own experience of going through an E5 interview process — in my [senior-and-above interview](#)

[preparation email series](#). For more details on these interviews, [sign up here](#) and you'll get access to the whole library of articles.

Engineering Manager Hiring

I write in detail about how Facebook hires engineering managers in the article [Hiring Engineer Managers](#). An extract from this article on what the process for hiring engineering managers typically looks like:

"Screening

- Recruiter call: with the recruiter who will be the point of contact for the process.
- Initial interview: with an EM.

Onsite

- *Career conversation*: topics about significant projects you have worked on to get a feel of your capabilities and how you work on teams and with other groups across an organization.
- *Project retrospective*: Using examples from your past, discuss the skills needed to deliver a project from start to finish.
- *People management*: your philosophy, process, and strategy around your management experience, as well as how you communicate effectively with your team.
- *Coding*: Solve a basic computer science problem. The problem will cover the basics of algorithms, data structures, design patterns, system design, complexity and basic coding.
- *Design (2x)*: testing your abilities to design systems / processes that scale in Facebook's environment. Explore the design of a complex system and the trade-offs within a design. Expectations at the EM level are typically for a slightly rusty senior engineer level."

Facebook is a company which only hires technical managers, and gathers signals on both coding, software architecture and design throughout the interviews. This makes

their engineering manager hiring loop one of the more challenging ones to clear within Big Tech.

The company does compensate for their high expectations with the detailed preparation materials, candidate preparation calls and mock interviews. Several engineering managers I talked with who got offers, made good use of these resources and spent time preparing for the technical interviews.

Compensation

Facebook's compensation structure consists of 4 pillars:

1. Base salary. Your cash salary. Base salary increases every year based on personal and company multipliers.

2. Equity. Facebook stock grants.

- **Initial grant.** Initial grants vest over 4 years. No cliff, quarterly vesting.
- **Annual refreshers.** Given together with the cash bonus, vesting over 3 years, starting immediately upon granting. Refresher = Equity target * personal multiplier * company multiplier.
- **AE (additional equity).** One-off equity refreshers given to a small percentage of engineers. Administered at Director-level. When awarding, your manager will not know about this award, unless your manager is at director-level. Often given as retainers to either high performers, to flight risks, or to those who have valid compensation complaints.
- **DE (discretionary equity.)** In the past, all AE was referred to as DE, but the name has been changed. These days, there are rumors that DE *still* exists on top of the well-understood AE. However, if it does, it is awarded much more rarely than AE.

3. Cash bonus. Awarded annually. Usual targets for the % of annual base salary. For targets, see the performance reviews section. Bonuses get paid out in two installments over the following 12 months. Bonus targets are locked to levels; see the performance reviews section for details on these targets. Bonus = Target * personal multiplier * company multiplier.

4. Sign-on bonus. Common to get the target cash bonus, and even more. For E6+ / M2+ roles bonuses in the \$50-100K+ range are not uncommon. Less likely to be granted outside engineering.

Compensation is highly formulaic with no space for adjustment outside of the formula, save for additional DE. See the Performance Reviews section for exact values for each level.

An example compensation package in the UK for a senior engineer (IC5):

Total compensation for the year: £230K as

- Base salary: £120K
- Initial equity grant: \$300K over 4 years
- Cash bonus: £18K
- Sign on bonus: £30K

Facebook makes top of the market offers. Facebook offers are typically at the [top of the highest tier](#) in how I like to think about compensation.

Talking with managers, they confirmed that Facebook targets the 90th percentile of the local market. For example, this means that in London, outside of hedge funds, few to no other companies pay better. Facebook always benchmarks salaries to the local market. This is why there is a noticeable gap between compensation packages in the US, in the UK and Switzerland.

As an example, here is an actual offer for an E7 in the US from late 2021:

- Total compensation: \$880K/year
- Base salary: \$275K
- Target bonus: 25%
- Sign-on: \$100K
- Equity: \$1.75M over 4 years

Negotiating compensation is possible, and common. I would know as I helped several people negotiate their initial Facebook offers. For IC4-and-above offers, it's easy to get a sign-on bonus, and for most offers negotiating on the stock grant is also possible. Some of this depends on how much leverage you have — like your current compensation or a competing offer — and how well you did in the interviews.

Facebook does have hard internal compensation limits which can only be ignored with VP-level approval. Several managers at Facebook shared how they consistently failed to get such approvals when trying to go above the band, when closing candidates with other very competitive offers, for example, from Google, or offers for a higher level at another Big Tech company.

Director-and-above compensation is even more competitive at Facebook than their already strong IC compensation structure. Having talked with people in these positions, it's rare that any company can compete with Facebook's leadership position compensation.

Negotiating a higher starting compensation evens out over time. Assuming you negotiate to get an offer at the top of the band, this means your salary will rise much more slowly than for someone who was hired at the lower part of the band. In general, after 1 or 2 years, these initial differences disappear by design, thanks to the formula-based compensation changes.

Equity refreshers and bonuses are blind to stock appreciation. This means you'll get the same equity refresh and cash bonus regardless of whether your former equity has increased in value by 10x, or if it has gone down since being issued.

This approach is at odds with how companies with frugality at their core like Amazon approach equity refreshers. At Amazon, as I detail in [Inside Amazon's Engineering Culture](#):

"While Amazon claims that equity refreshers are blind to stock appreciation, several managers I've talked with at Amazon shared how they feel this is not the case. Employees who have had equity appreciate significantly would often be given lower equity refreshers than similarly performing peers who had less outstanding equity."

In theory, compensation and career progression are designed to be separate. It's another standout difference vs many tech companies, and is designed purposely from the outset. One can make more money over a year at Facebook when being a level below another colleague. Performance reviews are designed to reward impact and these rewards can be larger than promotion rewards. Promotions reward both behavior and impact.

In practice, impact trumps everything. If engineers deliver outstanding impact, they are far more likely to get into the "Greatly Exceeds" bucket and also to get promoted. Getting "Greatly Exceeds" is especially challenging, especially at the higher levels (IC6+). Getting a "Greatly Exceeds" or "Redefines" almost always means a promotion.

It's common to make more total compensation at a level below by receiving a "Greatly Exceeds" or "Redefines" rating, than being a level above and receiving "Meets All" expectations. This is because although at a level above the cash bonus and equity refresh is higher, "Greatly Exceeds" means twice as much bonus as merely "Exceeds."

As a former Facebook IC6 engineer puts it:

"As an IC5, I constantly got "Exceeds" or "Greatly Exceeds" ratings, but once I reached IC6 I received "Meets All" more often. In a year, "Greatly Exceeds" at IC5 will have more bonus and stock grants (and therefore total annual comp) than IC6 "Meets All."

"The rating is based on impact and promotion is based on lagging behavior. Therefore focusing on impact will almost always lead to more financial rewards, and it sometimes also leads to promotion as well."

Starting at IC6, it's increasingly rare to earn more than a colleague one level higher up, especially because it's much more rare to get "Greatly Exceeds" or "Redefines" performance ratings. Facebook has clearly defined internal compensation bands with small overlaps between levels. Going above those bands requires VP-level approval and can be done with DE grants.

Despite all intentions, getting promoted is the surest way to get a meaningful compensation increase. This is also why many people at Facebook work hard for that

next promotion.

Stock price drops impact compensation heavily. Unlike Google, Apple, and Amazon which saw relatively stable stock prices up to May 2022, Facebook's stock price has seen a steep drop during the first part of 2022 due to Facebook's slowing growth, Apple's crackdown on tracking (impacting advertising efficiency at Facebook,) competition from TikTok and heavy investments in the new Metaverse.

How much control do managers have over compensation? They have no direct control. Compensation is entirely formulaic, depending on the level, function, location, and performance of the employee in the role.

This means that an engineer approaching their manager and telling them that they feel underpaid is not helpful. This is because managers do not have the tools to make one-off adjustments. The way to get compensation increases is to perform well by getting "Exceeds" or above performance ratings, to get promoted, or to qualify for an AE grant.

Grassroot compensation fairness groups have spawned at Facebook, over the year. These are bottom-up approaches, and these groups rely on employees to share their total compensation. As a former Facebook engineer shared:

"There's a giant group internally where you can reverse engineer the pay formulae across most roles/levels at the company - lots of people post their own screenshots of their own pay, or they contact someone anonymously who does it on their behalf. I found this in my first few weeks at the company and instantly meant that I knew exactly what I'd get paid if I got promoted to the next level, and so on. It was very eye-opening.

This group also makes it immediately apparent the wildly different salaries paid between locations. For example, the differences between London (LON) and Menlo Park (MPK). This is because as an employee in London you could realistically find an example of an MPK employee with exactly the same perf ratings/history as yourself and see how wildly different your pay packets were.

Internal mobility

Internal mobility is highly supported by Facebook, much more so than at similar companies. The reason is that Facebook wants engineers to vote with their feet for better projects and better engineering managers.

Things to know about internal mobility:

- **Engineers are typically not hired for a specific team, but choose one.** Only engineering managers and E6+ engineers are typically hired with their team confirmed before they start. For everyone else, they choose a team to join — which has available headcount — during Bootcamp. This approach of empowering engineers to choose their team is the case later on as well.
- **Moving teams is encouraged and not frowned upon.** This is true if people have only been on a team for a year. Many Facebook engineers have shared stories of working on several different teams over the course of a few years, and of feeling supported in changing teams and trying something new.
- **Hackamonth or Hackaquarter** is an opportunity to join another team for a month or a quarter, and to work on projects there. After this time, you can decide to stay on the new team, or return to your old one. Hackamonth is how many engineers validate that they would like to make the switch. Time spent on Hackamonth or Hackaquarter does count for your performance review, so doing poorly might pull it down somewhat, while delivering impact counts as a positive.
- **Mark yourself as open to moving.** With the internal People tool, you can mark yourself as available to work with other teams. Managers from other teams then reach out and it's common to find a new team this way.
- **Mobility between offices is common**, even internationally. As of early 2022, Facebook has engineering offices in the US in Menlo Park, Los Angeles, Seattle, New York City and Boston. International engineering offices include London, Dublin, Tel Aviv and Singapore, with more offices opening up over time. Facebook provides for relocation costs in moves between teams.
- **Formal interviews are banned for most internal moves.** By policy, teams are not allowed to interview engineers moving from one team to another, as long as they stay in the same role. This is by design, to keep internal mobility high.

- **Interviews are required when changing roles.** For example, if someone goes from an Enterprise Engineer to a Software Engineer, they have to go through the Software Engineer interview flow.
- **Mobility has its limits.** Although not common, I have confirmed a story where an IC7 was denied relocation to a smaller office because this satellite office did not have enough scope for them to operate in. As a rule of thumb, you need to find a team in the location to move to which has the scope for your level.
- **Salary adjustment.** Upon relocation, the salary, cash bonus and annual equity refresher bonuses are adjusted to local levels. Existing stock grants are kept. This means that when moving from places with higher total compensation bands like the Bay Area, to a lower cost office like London, the drop in total compensation is cushioned, thanks to the existing stock grants vesting.
- **Perks when seeding an office.** When Facebook started the London office, they “seeded” this office with a number of US employees. They encouraged these people to move by offering very generous perks: such as keeping their US salary for 2-3 years and getting £3000 a month on top of your normal pay just for housing. This approach worked well for seeding but later created friction when some of these people decided to stay in London. When doing so, their salaries were localized and they had to take significant pay cuts.

Perks

Facebook has some of the most lavish perks for full time employees of all Big Tech. This is a stark contrast to Amazon, which offers little to no comparable employee perks. Some perks worth mentioning:

- **Maternity and paternity:** 4 months of paid leave for newborns and adopted children.
- **Recharge:** a 30-day paid break every 5 years.
- **Wellness reimbursement discount:** up to \$3,000/year in refunds for qualifying services or purchases, from gyms to Apple Watch.
- **Facebook ads credit to use** like Facebook Business Ads Credits.

- **Company phone** with usage paid for, including unlimited data, even when traveling internationally.
- **Relocation package:** usually a strong offering with a mix of paying for relocation, and connecting with local relocation service providers.
- **Educational subscriptions:** LinkedIn Learning.
- **Office perks:** fully loaded micro kitchens with food and snacks.
- **Other perks:** life insurance, pension contribution / retirement plans, tax filing support (in the US, access to TurboTax), fertility benefits, a medical second opinion, and gender transition coverage.

Credits for those working in the office:

- **Lyft credits** in the US, outside of the Menlo Park location. \$200/month.

The list of perks is ever-changing; once you're inside Facebook, you have access to them. It's also worth asking around, as some local perks might be more hidden.

Alumni and boomerangs

Facebook has an official alumni group. They invite people who are marked as regretted attrition. Unlike Amazon where a good portion of leavers do so following a Focus or PIP and are non-regretted attrition, at Facebook the departures of the majority of people are regretted.

Investing. Facebook has an alumni investment syndicate called [Backed By Blue](#). While anyone can join this syndicate, their community section is limited to current and former Facebook employees.

Boomeranging — where someone leaves and then returns to the company later — is common at Facebook, which makes this easy to do. Usually no interviews are required when coming back within 6 months to the same level, except for a Behavioral interview, in some cases. Signing on bonuses cannot be awarded when boomeranging within a year of leaving.

Takeaways

In the first part of this two-part series, we have covered an overview of Facebook, and how it stands out from other Big Tech companies. The engineering-centric culture is distinctive. The focus on individual impact has served the company well over time, but in the past few years Facebook has tried to shift the focus onto teamwork - which still does not seem to be a completed process.

We went deep into how Facebook hires engineers and engineering managers. Out of all of Big Tech, Facebook provides the most support during the hiring process. This support helps offset the high expectations and thorough hiring process it runs for all hires.

Part 2 of the series is coming out next week. We will cover:

- **Career:** career ladders, axes, performance reviews, the calibration process, promotions
- **Engineering processes:** bootcamp, hackathons, testing, the tech stack, how teams and projects operate.
- **Advice:** How engineers and engineering managers can succeed at the company. Advice for founders on which parts of the Facebook engineering culture might be worth taking inspiration from, and why.

Thank you to the several people who helped contribute to these topics and reviewed the draft.

How did you like this week's newsletter? 🤔

[Amazing](#) • [Great](#) • [Good](#) • [OK](#) • [So-so](#)



136 Likes

14 Comments



Write a comment...



Adrian Mejia May 16, 2022 ❤️ Liked by Gergely Orosz

Great post and very insightful. By any chance, do you have (or plan to write) about "Inside Google's Engineering Culture"?

♡ LIKE (3) 💬 REPLY ...

2 replies by Gergely Orosz and others



Samuel Flender Writes Sam's Newsletter Feb 17 ❤️ Liked by Gergely Orosz

As a new Meta hire, this is the best resource I've found on Meta's culture, better than any of the internal resources that I've seen. I've been coming back here frequently. Thanks so much for this, Gergely!

♡ LIKE (2) 💬 REPLY ...

2 replies by Gergely Orosz and others

12 more comments...

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